THE TOP-GROSSING GAMES IN INDIA

(on Google Play, as on Feb. 16, 2022)

1


CLASH OF CLANS by Supercell — 500

2


GARENA FREE FIRE MAX by Garena International — 100

3


BATTLEGROUNDS MOBILE INDIA by Krafton, Inc. — 50

4


COIN MASTER by Moon Active — 100

6


TEEN PATTI OCTRO: 3 PATTI GAME by Octro, Inc. — 50

7


EFOOTBALL PES 2021 by Konami — 100

8


CALL OF DUTY MOBILE SEASON1 by Activision Publishing, Inc. — 100

9


EVONY: THE KING'S RETURN by TG Inc. — 50

remained available for download on Google Play Store at the time of writing this story.

In India, the gaming market has evolved from coin-based arcade games, such as Tekken in gaming parlours, to handheld consoles such as Nintendo, followed by PlayStation and Xboxes. A key factor that led to this growth was the high-paced development of technology infrastructure. In 2016, the launch of 4G services ensured high-speed internet and affordable data prices. The growth in digital payments infrastructure and in the internet and smartphone penetration helped too. An analysis by global consulting firm McKinsey found that, of the 17 mature and emerging economies, India is digitising faster than any other country, barring Indonesia. India is also slated to double the number of smartphones, to 650-700 million, by 2023. With the launch of 5G in India by next year, internet connections will have a higher bandwidth and lower response time, making the gaming experience all the more real-time. Plus, with schools and colleges shut due to the pandemic, many youngsters were compelled to give mobile gaming a try. In 2020, smartphone games accounted for almost 50 per cent of video gaming revenue worldwide.

WHY INDIA MATTERS

The huge demand from gamers is also driving game developers to work on India-focused content. "What works clearly for India is what I call ABCD—action, Bollywood, cricket and devotion," says Rajat Ojha, chief builder at Partynite.io, which calls itself "India's own metaverse". Some of the games developed in India include Real Snooker 3D developed by EivaaGames, World Cricket Championship developed by Nextwave Multimedia, FAU-G (Fearless and United Guards) developed by Bengaluru-based nCORE Games following the ban on PUBG, Ludo King from Mumbai-based Gametion Technologies, and Raji, an action-adventure game set in ancient India.

Just how important gaming has become for tech companies is evident from Microsoft's acquisition of California-based video game company Activision Blizzard Inc. in January for $69 billion (Rs 5.2 lakh crore), shattering all previous records. With this, Microsoft